A TALK — DENISON UNIVERSITY · 2026

My thoughts on *AI*, Agents, Careers & Consulting.

Jack Jin CLASS OF '06 · ACCENTURE

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Three parts

01

Why Now

The moment. Who I am.

02

The Demand

What the industry wants.

03

Your Move

What I would do in your seat.

Q&A

Your Turn

20 minutes. Ask anything.

I

Why Now.

The moment. Who I am. Why I'm standing here.

The clip that *sent me* down the rabbit hole.

Eighteen minutes in, something clicked. Nights, weekends, side projects — and eventually, this stage.

THE CLIP

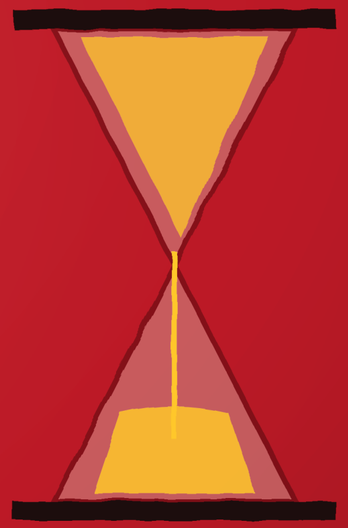
AI in Universities

OPEN ON YOUTUBE ↗

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BfBGhSqvcu4&t=1066s

Class of ’06

Consulting. Professional services. Happy tales and sad endings. AI Builder in Professional Services — and forever a student of Dr. Kretchmar.



PROOF OF WORK

built in < 1 hr

jackzhaojin/*denison-2026-04-24*

This deck. Built in under an hour. Source + slides live here.

repo → github.com/jackzhaojin/denison-2026-04-24

live → jackzhaojin.github.io/denison-2026-04-24/

PROOF OF WORK

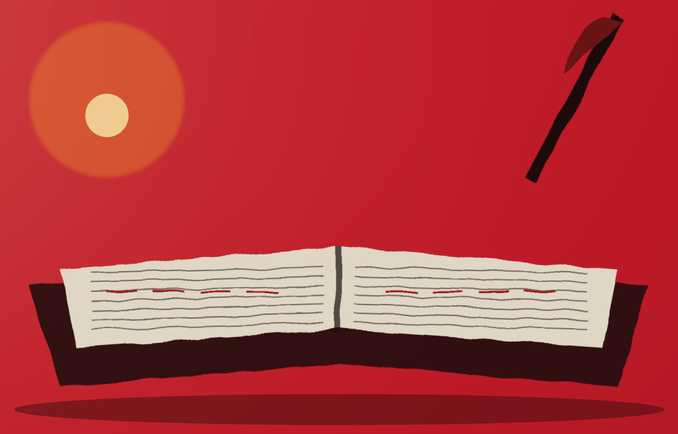
jackzhaojin/*continuous-agent*

A 24×7 coding agent. Runs while I sleep.

repo → github.com/jackzhaojin/continuous-agent

My AI moment.

Picture an accountant — twenty years of ledgers by hand — sitting down to Excel for the first time. Ten minutes in, they know everything is about to be reorganized. That is exactly what this felt like.



I didn't wait. *I built.*

Weekends. Side projects. Harnesses. A 24×7 coding agent that writes while I sleep. I treat it like a craft — and I spend serious hours sharpening it.

Three reasons I'm *here*.

It's good to *come back*.

Denison shaped how I think. I don't say that as a throwaway line.

I *believe* in this.

Like a preacher who might be wrong about the gospel — but believes it enough to climb the pulpit anyway.

Networking with future *talent*.

If I ran my own firm, I'd teach a university class full time — just to mentor and find talent without paying a recruiting fee. And the students would pay me to do it.

II

The Demand.

What Accenture — and the industry — is actually looking for.

A structural gap —

now

not a projection.

I help HR define some of the roles for what we're looking for — *AI-Native Engineers*.

We're hiring aggressively at all levels — with the right skillset.

Three *friction* points.

What I see holding experienced professionals back — every day.

A playbook for a *slower* world.

Copying a manager's path made sense when the technology shifted slowly enough that incremental was enough. That playbook is now broken — the tech moved faster than the habits.

Resistance, *not* ignorance.

Deep expertise meets a tool that appears to devalue it. Human, understandable — and significantly slowing things down. Accenture has 450,000 people in India alone. Small percentages add up fast.

“

Can someone give me an example of first principles thinking?

— (LET IT BREATHE.)

Reasoning from *analogy*, not truth.

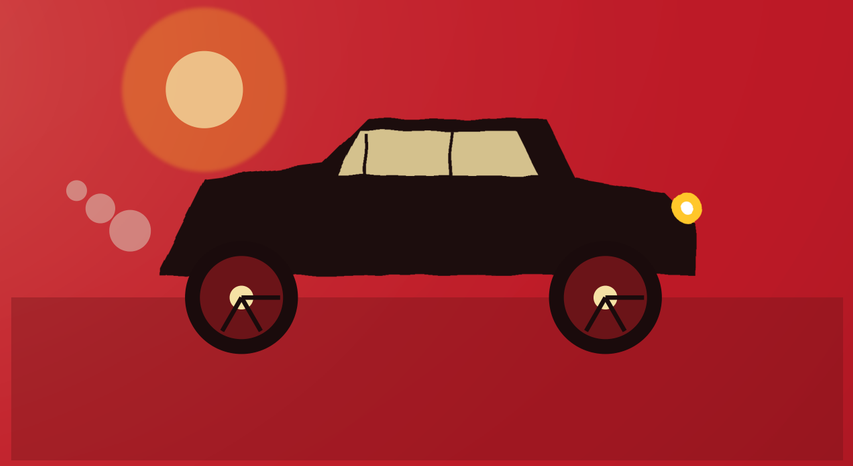
Breaking problems down to fundamentals and reasoning up from there — rather than from what worked before. In a rapidly changing environment, this is a critical weakness.

Why *you* have the edge.

Three advantages most people in the workforce don't have.

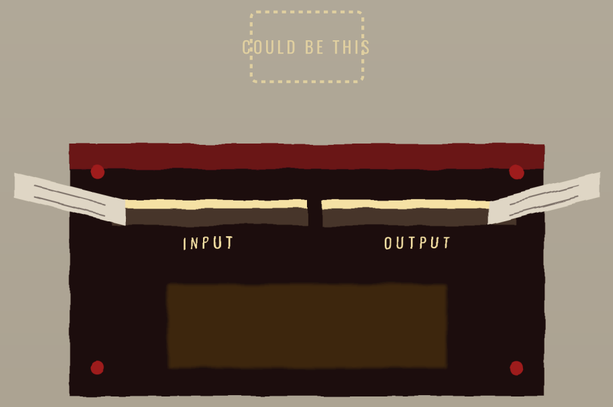
Native to the *agentic* era.

Unlearning is harder than learning. Twenty years ago, I was Google-native and my seniors weren't. Quiet edge, but real. Agentic-native now is the same edge — and the gap is significantly larger.



Some people have AI — and are still handing it *paper*.

Transformative technology used through the interface of the old world. You haven't accumulated fifteen years of 'the way we do it here.' Your instinct is still to ask why.



The market is *selective*. You can meet it.

CS hiring is harder. Entry-level roles are compressed. But firms like Accenture are still hiring — just not everyone, not evenly. Real AI fluency. Shipped something. First principles. Those are the students getting the calls.

Some skills will be worth much more. Some will be worth far less.

III

Your Move.

What I would do if I were sitting where you are.

He's doing most of the *building*.

We're making a video game together. He just goes. Figures it out. Ships. Watching him is the clearest picture I have of what I'd do if I were starting out today.

Six things I would actually *do*.

Sharpen these. In that order.

MOVE

1

Problem solving is the *job*.

AI does not replace it. It amplifies it. Decomposing broken, ambiguous situations is the root skill everything else grows from.

MOVE

2

Fundamentals still *matter*.

Data structures. Algorithms. How systems work under the hood. These are what let you use AI tools with judgment instead of hope.

MOVE

3

Side projects are the *résumé*.

GitHub isn't a portfolio — it's proof of work. A deployed side project you can explain with passion means a ton. Build something. Document it. Put it somewhere someone can see.

MOVE

4

Learn to *drive* the car.

Prompt well. Iterate fast. Evaluate outputs critically. Fluent use of AI is now a baseline professional skill. We're not looking for passengers.

REFERENCED TALK

"AI is hard to use well" — pragmaticengineer

AI Engineer Europe, April 2026

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CS5Cmz5FssI&t=698s

MOVE

5

Learn to change the *wheel, or, build a wheel*.

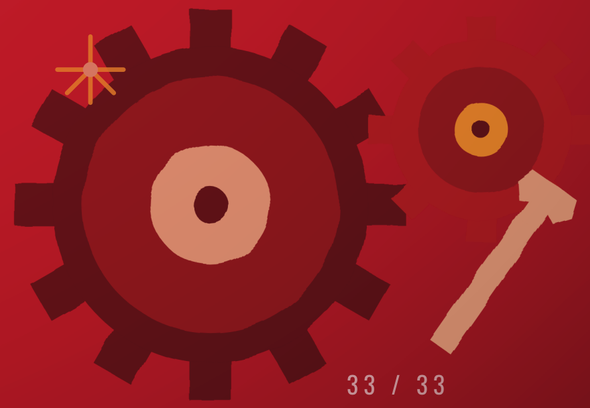
Design a chatbot with skills and tools — don't just use one. Reason through the architecture. Know where it breaks. That's the difference between a driver and someone who can pop the hood.

MOVE

6

Drive *multiple* cars at once.

Agent parallelism. Coordinating many agents. Rare territory. If you can do this coming out of college — really do it — you're in the top 1% of graduates entering the workforce right now.

Your *turn*.

Ask me anything — careers, AI, consulting, or building things.